

RENÉ GALICIA

EVP & CHIEF LEGAL COUNSEL
NTREIS

SHORT BIO

René Galicia is Executive Vice President & Chief Legal Counsel at NTREIS, the MLS serving 50,000+ subscribers across 13 REALTOR® associations in Texas and Louisiana. He oversees strategic operations and serves as NTREIS's principal legal advisor. René brings more than 20 years of MLS industry experience, including senior roles at the Council of MLS (CMLS), Bright MLS, the National Association of REALTORS® (NAR) and California Regional MLS (CRMLS). He holds a J.D. from Pacific Coast University School of Law and the CMLX-1 designation, was named a 2023 HousingWire Vanguard, and was selected for the 2026 Swanepoel Power 200 Watchlist.

FULL BIO

René Galicia is Executive Vice President & Chief Legal Counsel at NTREIS, the MLS serving 50,000+ subscribers across 13 REALTOR® associations in Texas and Louisiana. He joined NTREIS in October 2025 in a newly created role, where he oversees strategic operations and serves as the organization's principal legal advisor.

Before NTREIS, René served as Chief Operating Officer of the Council of MLS (CMLS), after joining its Board of Directors in early 2025. From 2021 to 2025, he was an EVP at Bright MLS, first leading Customer Advocacy (Customer Support, Compliance and Engagement) and later Policy Counsel & Strategic Partnerships. At Bright, he expanded subscriber feedback programs using NPS methodology, led policy initiatives in response to industry change, and built partnerships that widened access to listing data.

From 2018 to 2021, René was Director of MLS Engagement at NAR, where he managed relationships between NAR and nearly 600 MLSs nationwide. He served as Staff Executive for the MLS Executives Advisory Board and as NAR's liaison to RESO and CMLS.

René began his MLS career at CRMLS, where he spent more than seven years rising from documentation specialist to training supervisor and, ultimately, Director of Compliance & Data Licensing. In that role he led a team of 12 compliance analysts enforcing MLS rules for about 95,000 subscribers, and he managed contracting and compliance for more than 20,000 IDX websites and over 100 vendor agreements. He was named a 2023 HousingWire Vanguard and was selected for the 2026 Swanepoel Power 200 (SP200) Watchlist, which recognizes rising leaders in North American residential real estate.

René earned his Juris Doctor from Pacific Coast University School of Law in Long Beach, California. He also holds a mediation certificate from Pepperdine University's Straus Institute for Dispute Resolution and completed General Counsel University through UC Berkeley School of Law Executive Education.

QUICK FACTS

- **Role:** EVP & Chief Legal Counsel, NTREIS (since October 2025)
- **Previously:** COO, CMLS; EVP, Bright MLS; Director of MLS Engagement, NAR
- **Education:** J.D., Pacific Coast University School of Law
- **NAR Certifications:** e-PRO, At Home With Diversity, Commitment to Excellence, Professional Standards Administration
- **Designation:** CMLX-1, Council of MLS

NOTABLE HONORS

- 2026 Swanepoel Power 200 Watchlist
- 2025 CMLS Board of Directors
- 2023 HousingWire Vanguard

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